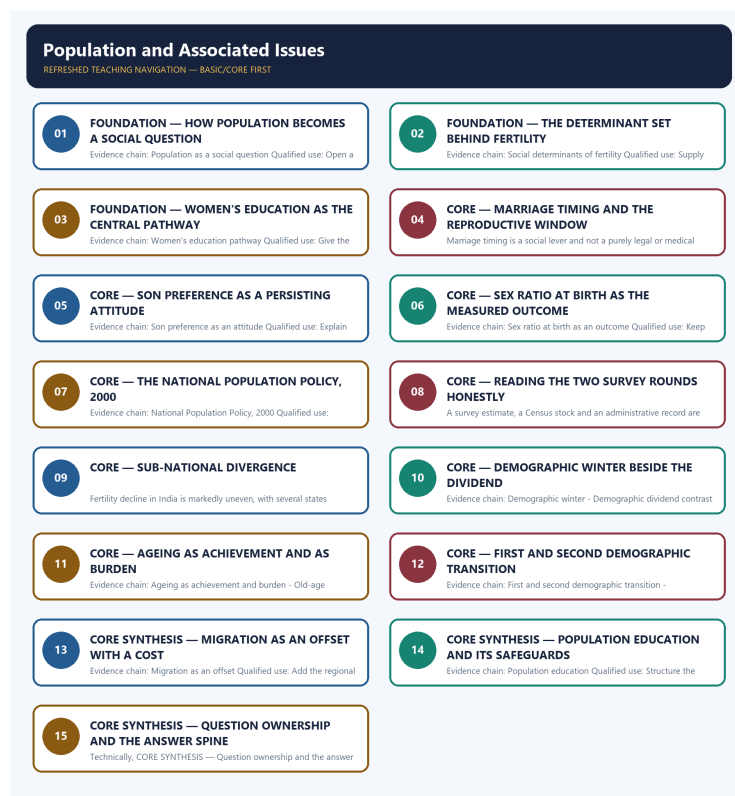


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Population and Associated Issues - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Population and Associated Issues - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Population as a social question?

A. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. B. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. C. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. D. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.

Answer: A. Explanation: Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Population as a social question?

A. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. B. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. C. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. D. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.

Answer: B. Explanation: Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Population as a social question?

A. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. B. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. C. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. D. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage

timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.

Answer: C. Explanation: Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Population as a social question?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. C. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. D. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived.

Answer: D. Explanation: Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Social determinants of fertility?

A. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. D. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Social determinants of fertility?

A. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. B. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. C. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. D. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Social determinants of fertility?

A. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. B. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. C. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Social determinants of fertility?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. C. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. D. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size,

contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Women's education pathway?

A. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. D. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter.

Answer: A. Explanation: Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Women's education pathway?

A. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. B. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. C. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: B. Explanation: Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Women's education pathway?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. C. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. D. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

Answer: C. Explanation: Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Women's education pathway?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. D. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.

Answer: D. Explanation: Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Age at marriage?

A. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. B. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. C. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: A. Explanation: A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Age at marriage?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. D. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

Answer: B. Explanation: A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Age at marriage?

A. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: C. Explanation: A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Age at marriage?

A. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. B. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. C. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. D. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.

Answer: D. Explanation: A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Son preference as an attitude?

A. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. B. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. C. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: A. Explanation: Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Son preference as an attitude?

A. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. B. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. C. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: B. Explanation: Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Son preference as an attitude?

A. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. D. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Son preference as an attitude?

A. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. D. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size.

Answer: D. Explanation: Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Sex ratio at birth as an outcome?

A. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. B. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. C. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. D. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet.

Answer: A. Explanation: The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Sex ratio at birth as an outcome?

A. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. B. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. C. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. D. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sex ratio at birth as an outcome?

A. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. B. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. C. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. D. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Answer: C. Explanation: The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sex ratio at birth as an outcome?

A. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. B. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. C. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. D. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter.

Answer: D. Explanation: The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies National Population Policy, 2000?

A. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. B. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. C. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. D. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under National Population Policy, 2000?

A. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. B. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. C. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. D. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a

current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of National Population Policy, 2000?

A. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. B. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. C. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. D. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about National Population Policy, 2000?

A. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. B. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. C. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. D. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies NFHS-5 as a historical comparator?

A. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. D. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under NFHS-5 as a historical comparator?

A. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. B. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. C. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. D. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of NFHS-5 as a historical comparator?

A. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. B. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. C. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. D. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about NFHS-5 as a historical comparator?

A. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. D. The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies NFHS-6 release and provisional status?

A. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. B. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. C. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. D. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under NFHS-6 release and provisional status?

A. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. B. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. C. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. D. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of NFHS-6 release and provisional status?

A. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. D. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about NFHS-6 release and provisional status?

A. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. D. The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Survey is not a census stock?

A. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. B. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. C. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. D. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average.

Answer: A. Explanation: A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. The remaining

options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Survey is not a census stock?

A. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. B. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. C. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. D. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one.

Answer: B. Explanation: A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Survey is not a census stock?

A. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. D. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Answer: C. Explanation: A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Survey is not a census stock?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. C. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. D. A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Answer: D. Explanation: A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Sub-national divergence?

A. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. B. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. C. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. D. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Answer: A. Explanation: Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Sub-national divergence?

A. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. B. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. C. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. D. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing.

Answer: B. Explanation: Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sub-national divergence?

A. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. B. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. C. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. D. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing.

Answer: C. Explanation: Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sub-national divergence?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Answer: D. Explanation: Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Demographic winter?

A. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. D. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Answer: A. Explanation: Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Demographic winter?

A. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. B. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. C. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. D. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.

Answer: B. Explanation: Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Demographic winter?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. C. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. D. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing.

Answer: C. Explanation: Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Demographic winter?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average.

Answer: D. Explanation: Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Demographic dividend contrast?

A. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. B. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. C. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. D. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one.

Answer: A. Explanation: The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition,

and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Demographic dividend contrast?

A. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. B. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.

Answer: B. Explanation: The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Demographic dividend contrast?

A. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. B. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. C. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. D. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.

Answer: C. Explanation: The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Demographic dividend contrast?

A. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. B. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Answer: D. Explanation: The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Ageing as achievement and burden?

A. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. B. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.

Answer: A. Explanation: Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Ageing as achievement and burden?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. C. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. D. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ageing as achievement and burden?

A. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. B. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. C. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. D. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit

anti-coercion safeguards.

Answer: C. Explanation: Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ageing as achievement and burden?

A. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. B. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. C. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. D. Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Old-age dependency and family support?

A. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. B. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. C. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. D. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions.

Answer: A. Explanation: A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Old-age dependency and family support?

A. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. B. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. C. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community

outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. D. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Old-age dependency and family support?

A. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. B. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. C. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. D. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it.

Answer: C. Explanation: A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Old-age dependency and family support?

A. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. B. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. C. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. D. A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing.

Answer: D. Explanation: A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies First and second demographic transition?

A. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. B. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under First and second demographic transition?

A. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. B. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. C. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. D. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of First and second demographic transition?

A. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. B. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach

and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. C. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. D. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived.

Answer: C. Explanation: The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about First and second demographic transition?

A. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. B. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. C. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. D. The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.

Answer: D. Explanation: The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Urbanisation and the cost of children?

A. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. B. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. C. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. D. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Urbanisation and the cost of children?

A. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. B. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. C. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. D. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Urbanisation and the cost of children?

A. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. B. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. C. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. D. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived.

Answer: C. Explanation: Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Urbanisation and the cost of children?

A. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. B. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. C. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. D. Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Migration as an offset?

A. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. B. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. C. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. D. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Migration as an offset?

A. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. B. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. C. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. D. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size,

contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Migration as an offset?

A. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. B. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. C. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. D. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Migration as an offset?

A. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. D. Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Population education?

A. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. B. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. C. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their

joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. D. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Population education?

A. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. B. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. C. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. D. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Population education?

A. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. D. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.

Answer: C. Explanation: Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. The remaining options belong to

different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Population education?

A. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. B. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. C. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. D. Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards.

Answer: D. Explanation: Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. B. Population change is treated in this owner as a social process shaped by schooling, marriage timing, desired family size, son preference, health services and contraceptive access, while the stage-based demographic transition model and dividend theory remain the property of Geography and are cross-linked rather than re-derived. C. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. D. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.

Answer: A. Explanation: Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. B. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. C. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. D. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.

Answer: B. Explanation: Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. B. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. C. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. D. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size.

Answer: C. Explanation: Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified direct Mains demands?

A. Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. B. The sex ratio at birth is the measurable demographic outcome through which son preference becomes visible in parts of India, so the attitude and the metric must be named separately and the legal-regulatory response to sex selection remains a Social Justice and Polity matter. C. A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. D. Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Three direct General Studies Paper-I demands are carried by this owner: the 2019 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth worth 10 marks and the 2021 demand on the objectives of population education and the measures India needs worth 15 marks, both routed in the audited 2018-2023 ledger to the Advanced owner with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes, and the 2024 demographic-winter demand worth 10 marks whose ledger route names the Geography population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three direct General Studies Paper-I Mains demands are carried by this owner and each is recorded with its exact routing status. The 2019 Q9 demand on empowering women in relation to population growth and the 2021 Q18 demand on the objectives of population education are routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner, while the Core owner's own answer-architecture table records that Core routing supersedes those pointers, so both are answered here from the Basic spine. The locally held official question papers for 2019 and 2021 are scanned images from which reliable text cannot be extracted, so the audited ledger's neutral demand rendering is used and no verbatim wording is claimed for those two years. The 2024 Q7 demographic-winter demand is different: its ledger row names the Geography world-population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it, and that cross-owner conflict is stated openly here rather than resolved by an unsupported analytical claim. Its wording was confirmed in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I. No marking scheme, official key or model answer of the Union Public Service Commission is held locally, and none is reproduced or inferred.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the central concept and separate it from the nearest social or legal category. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace the historical and institutional setting instead of assuming a timeless practice. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical

scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Explain the norm, incentive, network, power or agency mechanism producing the outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Use one named Indian community, movement, region, institution or source-dated dataset. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualify the pattern through intersectionality, regional variation, causation and implementation limits. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

5. Indian applications and PYQ mapping

- FACT: **2024 GS-I PYQ (10 marks, verbatim):** "What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'?"

Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate." The expected answer: define demographic winter as sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual decline; note that several developed countries and some Indian states already show this pattern, while India in aggregate and many developing countries remain above replacement, so the world is moving toward this situation unevenly rather than uniformly, with social causes (women's education, delayed marriage, urbanisation, rising child-rearing cost) driving the shift.

- ANALYSIS: A state with a Total Fertility Rate already below replacement level illustrates localised "demographic winter" conditions coexisting with a still-younger national average.

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (10 marks):** define demographic winter precisely, use global population evidence for the world-level claim, and use the dated NFHS-5 TFR of 2.0 only as an Indian survey anchor while flagging sub-national variation. Conclude that movement toward it is uneven, not a single global or Indian fact.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2024 GS-I (10 marks, verbatim):** "What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate." Analytical route: (a) define demographic winter precisely as sustained sub-replacement fertility with ageing and eventual decline; (b) cite the dated NFHS-5 national TFR of 2.0 as the Indian anchor while explicitly flagging sub-national divergence; (c) note several developed countries are already well into demographic-winter conditions; (d) conclude the world is moving toward this situation unevenly - some regions already there, others (with continued high fertility) still distant - driven by the same social determinants that explain ordinary fertility decline.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-I	9	Empowering women as key to controlling population growth	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2021	GS-I	18	Objectives of population education and measures for India	Discuss and point out · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Empowering women as key to controlling population growth
- Objectives of population education and measures for India

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I Q9

Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: empowering women as key to controlling population growth. Discuss, 10 marks, 150 words.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner, with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes. The locally held official 2019 paper is a scanned image without reliable text extraction, so the ledger rendering is used and no verbatim wording is claimed.

Model solution: Reframe the demand before answering it: the examinable claim is that expanding women's capability, not administering population control, is what lowers fertility, so the answer tests a mechanism rather than endorsing a slogan. Establish the mechanism. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, with wider knowledge and use of contraception and with a broader set of life options, and a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window while improving maternal and child health outcomes; the qualification is that these are interacting associations operating alongside service access, income, norms and state context, so no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause. Add the policy anchor. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare is tiered around unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, which shows that India's own stated framework is rights-based rather than coercive; the qualification is that a stated objective is not an achieved outcome. Show the limit of the empowerment claim. Son preference is an attitude rooted in inheritance rules and old-age support expectations and it can persist after desired family size has already fallen, so households may continue childbearing until a son is born even where women's schooling has risen, which means empowerment shifts the size decision faster than it shifts the composition decision. Close with a qualified verdict: empowerment is the most defensible route because it enlarges informed and voluntary choice and simultaneously improves health outcomes, but it must be paired with contraceptive access, marriage-timing support and work on son preference, and the outcome will remain state-graded because fertility in India is markedly uneven. Quote no state fertility value and no dependency figure that this owner does not carry.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I Q9", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reframe the demand before answering it: the examinable claim is that expanding women's capability, not administering population control, is what lowers fertility, so the answer tests a mechanism rather than endorsing a slogan. Establish the mechanism. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, with wider knowledge and use of contraception and with a broader set of life options, and a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window while improving maternal and child health outcomes; the qualification is that these are interacting associations operating alongside service access, income, norms and state context, so no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause. Add the policy anchor. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare is tiered around unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, which shows that India's own stated framework is rights-based rather than coercive; the qualification is that a stated objective is not an achieved outcome. Show the limit of the empowerment claim. Son preference is an attitude rooted in inheritance rules and old-age support expectations and it can persist after desired family size has already fallen, so households may continue childbearing until a son is born even where women's schooling has risen, which means empowerment shifts the size decision faster than it shifts the composition decision. Close with a qualified verdict: empowerment is the most defensible route because it enlarges informed and voluntary choice and simultaneously improves health outcomes, but it must be paired with contraceptive access, marriage-timing support and work on son preference, and the outcome will remain state-graded because fertility in India is markedly uneven. Quote no state fertility value and no dependency figure that this owner does not carry.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: empowering women as key to controlling population growth. Discuss, 10 marks, 150 words. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reframe the demand before answering it: the examinable claim is that expanding women's capability, not administering population control, is what lowers fertility, so the answer tests a mechanism rather than endorsing a slogan. Establish the mechanism. Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, with wider knowledge and use of contraception and with a broader set of life options, and a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window while improving maternal and child health outcomes; the qualification is that these are interacting associations operating alongside service access, income, norms and state context, so no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause. Add the policy anchor. The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare is tiered around unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, which shows that India's own stated framework is rights-based rather than coercive; the qualification is that a stated objective is not an achieved outcome. Show the limit of the empowerment claim. Son preference is an attitude rooted in inheritance rules and old-age support expectations and it can persist after desired family size has already fallen, so households may continue childbearing until a son is born even where women's schooling has risen, which means empowerment shifts the size decision faster than it shifts the composition decision. Close with a qualified verdict: empowerment is the most defensible route because it enlarges informed and voluntary choice and simultaneously improves health outcomes, but it must be paired with contraceptive access, marriage-timing support and work on son preference, and the outcome will remain state-graded because fertility in India is markedly uneven. Quote no state fertility value and no dependency figure that this owner does not carry.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named

evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-I Q9", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-I Q18

Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: objectives of population education and the measures India needs. Discuss and point out, 15 marks, 250 words.

Status: Routed in the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner, with the Core owner recording that Core routing supersedes. The locally held official 2021 paper is a scanned image without reliable text extraction, so the ledger rendering is used and no verbatim wording is claimed.

Model solution: Define the subject precisely at the start: population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education about population processes and their social consequences, and it is not a persuasion campaign attached to a numerical target. Group the objectives so that the discuss half of the directive is visibly organised. First, reproductive and health information that allows informed decisions about marriage timing, spacing and maternal and child health. Second, gender equality and delayed marriage, because a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and improves maternal and child outcomes while women's educational attainment widens life options. Third, informed and voluntary family-size choice framed as capability rather than compliance. Fourth, awareness of the relationship between population, resources and services so that pressure on schooling, housing and health provision is understood rather than moralised. Then point out the measures, which is the second half of the directive and where most answers thin out. Deliver the content through school curricula at age-appropriate stages, through community outreach that reaches out-of-school adolescents, and through frontline health services so that information and access arrive together rather than separately. Locate the whole design inside the National Population Policy, 2000 frame of unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, and attach explicit anti-coercion safeguards so the programme cannot slide into target-setting. Qualify the recommendation honestly. Fertility in India is markedly uneven across states, so identical content will meet very different conditions, and the National Family Health Survey rounds are survey estimates rather than Census stocks, so they may indicate direction without supplying a state-uniform target. Conclude that population education succeeds when it expands informed capability and fails the moment it becomes demographic instruction.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-I Q18", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Define the subject precisely at the start: population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education about population processes and their social consequences, and it is not a persuasion campaign attached to a numerical target. Group the objectives so that the discuss half of the directive is visibly organised. First, reproductive and health information that allows informed decisions about marriage timing, spacing and maternal and child health. Second, gender equality and delayed marriage, because a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and improves maternal and child outcomes while women's educational attainment widens life options. Third, informed and voluntary family-size choice framed as capability rather than compliance. Fourth, awareness of the relationship between population, resources and services so that pressure on schooling, housing and health provision is understood rather than moralised. Then point out the measures, which is the second half of the directive and where most answers thin out. Deliver the content through school curricula at age-appropriate stages, through community outreach that reaches out-of-school adolescents, and through frontline health services so that information and access arrive together rather than separately. Locate the whole design inside the National Population Policy, 2000 frame of unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, and attach explicit anti-coercion safeguards so the programme

cannot slide into target-setting. Qualify the recommendation honestly. Fertility in India is markedly uneven across states, so identical content will meet very different conditions, and the National Family Health Survey rounds are survey estimates rather than Census stocks, so they may indicate direction without supplying a state-uniform target. Conclude that population education succeeds when it expands informed capability and fails the moment it becomes demographic instruction.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Audited ledger demand rendering: objectives of population education and the measures India needs. Discuss and point out, 15 marks, 250 words. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Define the subject precisely at the start: population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education about population processes and their social consequences, and it is not a persuasion campaign attached to a numerical target. Group the objectives so that the discuss half of the directive is visibly organised. First, reproductive and health information that allows informed decisions about marriage timing, spacing and maternal and child health. Second, gender equality and delayed marriage, because a later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and improves maternal and child outcomes while women's educational attainment widens life options. Third, informed and voluntary family-size choice framed as capability rather than compliance. Fourth, awareness of the relationship between population, resources and services so that pressure on schooling, housing and health provision is understood rather than moralised. Then point out the measures, which is the second half of the directive and where most answers thin out. Deliver the content through school curricula at age-appropriate stages, through community outreach that reaches out-of-school adolescents, and through frontline health services so that information and access arrive together rather than separately. Locate the whole design inside the National Population Policy, 2000 frame of unmet contraceptive need, replacement-level fertility and long-term stabilisation aligned with sustainable development, and attach explicit anti-coercion safeguards so the programme cannot slide into target-setting. Qualify the recommendation honestly. Fertility in India is markedly uneven across states, so identical content will meet very different conditions, and the National Family Health Survey rounds are survey estimates rather than Census stocks, so they may indicate direction without supplying a state-uniform target. Conclude that population education succeeds when it expands informed capability and fails the moment it becomes demographic instruction.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-I Q18", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I Q7

Demand: What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks.

Status: Wording confirmed in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-I. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes this row to the Geography world-population owner while this owner's own answer-architecture table claims it; the conflict is recorded openly and this answer is written from the Indian Society social-demography spine without claiming the Geography model owner's material.

Model solution: Define first and define tightly: demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, with workforce shrinkage and old-age support strain as its consequences. Immediately separate it from the demographic dividend, which describes the potentially growth-favourable window when the working-age share is largest; the two are near-opposite phases of the same transition and conflating them is the commonest error on this demand. Answer the second half as a graded process rather than a yes or no. Several populations are already inside the condition because fertility fell early and life expectancy continued rising, while other populations remain meaningfully above replacement, so the world is moving toward the condition unevenly rather than uniformly. Bring the Indian evidence with its status attached: the National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026, reports a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1 and labels its results provisional, and the earlier round five figure of 2.0 for 2019-21 is a historical comparator; neither is a Census stock and neither describes any individual state. State the aggregation limit explicitly, because it is the analytical move the demand rewards: fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, so a near-replacement national figure simultaneously conceals states already below replacement, where ageing pressure and a rising old-age dependency ratio meet a still predominantly family-based support system, and states still above replacement retaining an open dividend window. Name the drivers common to both halves, namely women's education, later marriage, urbanisation and the rising direct and opportunity cost of children, and add second demographic transition theory only as a European-derived lens rather than an established Indian diagnosis. Conclude that demographic winter is a conditional, regionally graded risk rather than a settled global fact, and that the policy question is therefore about preparing differing regional age structures rather than about reversing a single number.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I Q7", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Define first and define tightly: demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, with workforce shrinkage and old-age support strain as its consequences. Immediately separate it from the demographic dividend, which describes the potentially growth-favourable window when the working-age share is largest; the two are near-opposite phases of the same transition and conflating them is the commonest error on this demand. Answer the second half as a graded process rather than a yes or no. Several populations are already inside the condition because fertility fell early and life expectancy continued rising, while other populations remain meaningfully above replacement, so the world is moving toward the condition unevenly rather than uniformly. Bring the Indian evidence with its status attached: the National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026, reports a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1 and labels its results provisional, and the earlier round five figure of 2.0 for 2019-21 is a historical comparator; neither is a Census stock and neither describes any individual state. State the aggregation limit explicitly, because it is the analytical move the demand rewards: fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, so a near-replacement national figure simultaneously conceals states already below replacement, where ageing pressure and a rising old-age dependency ratio meet a still predominantly family-based support system, and states still above replacement retaining an open dividend window. Name the drivers common to both halves, namely women's education, later marriage, urbanisation and the rising direct and opportunity cost of children, and add second demographic transition theory only as a European-derived lens rather than an established Indian diagnosis. Conclude that demographic winter is a conditional, regionally graded risk rather than a settled global fact, and that the policy question is therefore about preparing differing regional age structures rather than about reversing a single number.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate. (Answer in 150 words) 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Define first and define tightly: demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, with workforce shrinkage and old-age support strain as its consequences. Immediately separate it from the demographic dividend, which describes the potentially growth-favourable window when the working-age share is largest; the two are near-opposite phases of the same transition and conflating them is the commonest error on this demand. Answer the second half as a graded process rather than a yes or no. Several populations are already inside the condition because fertility fell early and life expectancy continued rising, while other populations remain meaningfully above replacement, so the world is moving toward the condition unevenly rather than uniformly. Bring the Indian evidence with its status attached: the National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24 and released on 29 May 2026, reports a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1 and labels its results provisional, and the earlier round five figure of 2.0 for 2019-21 is a historical comparator; neither is a Census stock and neither describes any individual state. State the aggregation limit explicitly, because it is the analytical move the demand rewards: fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, so a near-replacement national figure simultaneously conceals states already below replacement, where ageing pressure and a rising old-age dependency ratio meet a still predominantly family-based support system, and states still above replacement retaining an open dividend window. Name the drivers common to both halves, namely women's education, later marriage, urbanisation and the rising direct and opportunity cost of children, and add second demographic transition theory only as a European-derived lens rather than an established Indian diagnosis. Conclude that demographic winter is a conditional, regionally graded risk rather than a settled global fact, and that the policy question is therefore about preparing differing regional age structures rather than about reversing a single number.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2024 GS-I Q7", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Discuss the social determinants of fertility decline in India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Fertility decline in India is produced by schooling, marriage timing, contraceptive access and the changing cost of children acting together, so the honest account names an interacting determinant set rather than promoting one factor to sole cause.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.

- Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.
- A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.
- Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions.
- Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Qualified conclusion: Fertility decline in India is produced by schooling, marriage timing, contraceptive access and the changing cost of children acting together, so the honest account names an interacting determinant set rather than promoting one factor to sole cause.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the social determinants of fertility decline in India. Answer in about 150 words.", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Fertility decline in India is produced by schooling, marriage timing, contraceptive access and the changing cost of children acting together, so the honest account names an interacting determinant set rather than promoting one factor to sole cause.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Urban residence raises both the direct cost of raising children through housing and schooling expenditure and the opportunity cost through foregone earnings, which is why urbanisation appears repeatedly in fertility explanations as an economic pressure operating through social decisions. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Fertility decline in India is produced by schooling, marriage timing, contraceptive access and the changing cost of children acting together, so the honest account names an interacting determinant set rather than promoting one factor to sole cause.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the social determinants of fertility decline in India. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish demographic winter from the demographic dividend and state which one describes India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The two terms name near-opposite phases of transition, and because Indian fertility is sharply uneven neither label describes the whole country, so the correct answer is a state-graded one supported by a dated survey anchor.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average.
- The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.
- Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.
- The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

Qualified conclusion: The two terms name near-opposite phases of transition, and because Indian fertility is sharply uneven neither label describes the whole country, so the correct answer is a state-graded one supported by a dated survey anchor.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish demographic winter from the demographic dividend and state which one describes...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The two terms name near-opposite phases of transition, and because Indian fertility is sharply uneven neither label describes the whole country, so the correct answer is a state-graded one supported by a dated survey anchor.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility combined with population ageing and eventual population decline, raising concerns about workforce shrinkage and old-age support, and it is a conditional population pattern rather than a label that can be attached to a whole country from one national average. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The two terms name near-opposite phases of transition, and because Indian fertility is sharply uneven neither label describes the whole country, so the correct answer is a state-graded one supported by a dated survey anchor.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish demographic winter from the demographic dividend and state which one describes...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the proposition that empowering women is the key to controlling population growth. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Women's education, later marriage, health information and economic voice expand informed and voluntary family-size choice, which is why empowerment outperforms control as a policy frame, though son preference and uneven service access qualify how far agency alone can carry the outcome.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.
- A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable.
- Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size.
- Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.
- Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards.

Qualified conclusion: Women's education, later marriage, health information and economic voice expand informed and voluntary family-size choice, which is why empowerment outperforms control as a policy frame, though son preference and uneven service access qualify how far agency alone can carry the outcome.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the proposition that empowering women is the key to controlling population growth....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Women's education, later marriage, health information and economic voice expand informed and voluntary family-size choice, which is why empowerment outperforms control as a policy frame, though son preference and uneven service access qualify how far agency alone can carry the outcome.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A later age at marriage compresses the reproductive window and is associated with better maternal and child health outcomes, which makes marriage timing a social lever that works alongside contraceptive access rather than a purely legal or medical variable. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Son preference is a social preference for male children linked historically to inheritance rules, old-age support expectations and patrilineal family structure, and because it is attitudinal it can persist even after a household has reduced its overall desired family size. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Women's education, later marriage, health information and economic voice expand informed and voluntary family-size choice, which is why empowerment outperforms control as a policy frame, though son preference and uneven service access qualify how far agency alone can carry the outcome.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the proposition that empowering women is the key to controlling population growth...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why a national fertility aggregate can mask sharp sub-national demographic divergence in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: A national average is a weighted summary of states in different transition phases, so it simultaneously conceals localised ageing pressure and continuing high-fertility conditions, and any policy inference drawn from the aggregate alone is therefore unsafe.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.
- The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value.

- The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet.
- A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.
- The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Qualified conclusion: A national average is a weighted summary of states in different transition phases, so it simultaneously conceals localised ageing pressure and continuing high-fertility conditions, and any policy inference drawn from the aggregate alone is therefore unsafe.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why a national fertility aggregate can mask sharp sub-national demographic divergence...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A national average is a weighted summary of states in different transition phases, so it simultaneously conceals localised ageing pressure and continuing high-fertility conditions, and any policy inference drawn from the aggregate alone is therefore unsafe.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Family Health Survey round five, covering 2019-21, reported an all-India Total Fertility Rate of 2.0, and after the release of the sixth round this figure functions as a dated historical comparator that shows direction rather than a current-year or state-uniform value. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Family Health Survey round six, covering 2023-24, was released on 29 May 2026 and its national fact sheets report a total Total Fertility Rate of 2.0 with an urban value of 1.6 and a rural value of 2.1, and because the fact sheets label the results provisional no metric may be quoted unless it is taken directly from that released national fact sheet. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The demographic dividend describes the potentially growth-favourable window in which the working-age share is largest, so it and demographic winter are near-opposite phases of transition, and a large country can show ageing pressure in some states while other states retain an open dividend window.

Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: A national average is a weighted summary of states in different transition phases, so it simultaneously conceals localised ageing pressure and continuing high-fertility conditions, and any policy inference drawn from the aggregate alone is therefore unsafe.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine why a national fertility aggregate can mask sharp sub-national demographic divergence...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the social implications of India's transition toward an ageing population structure. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Ageing is the success of an earlier health and fertility transition arriving as a care, workforce and security problem, and its severity depends on how fast formal support has been built where fertility fell earliest rather than on the national age structure.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one.
- A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing.
- The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state.
- Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it.
- Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing.

Qualified conclusion: Ageing is the success of an earlier health and fertility transition arriving as a care, workforce and security problem, and its severity depends on how fast formal support has been built where fertility fell earliest rather than on the national age structure.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the social implications of India's transition toward an ageing population structure....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Ageing is the success of an earlier health and fertility transition arriving as a care, workforce and security problem, and its severity depends on how fast formal support has been built where fertility fell earliest rather than on the national age structure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Population ageing simultaneously reflects the success of mortality and fertility transition and creates old-age support and workforce-composition challenges, so a competent answer holds both framings together instead of choosing one. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A rising old-age dependency ratio strains a support system that in India is still predominantly family-based, and nuclearisation reduces co-resident caregiving capacity while formal old-age social security, whose scheme detail belongs to Social Justice, is in most states not yet scaled to the pace of ageing. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The first demographic transition describes mortality decline followed by fertility decline, while second demographic transition theory links further sub-replacement fertility to shifts in values and family formation, and the second framework was developed largely from European experience and is an analytical lens rather than a sufficient diagnosis of any Indian state. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Internal migration can offset workforce shrinkage in a receiving region while straining the sending region's own ageing-support capacity when working-age adults leave elderly parents behind, so migration is a redistribution of the ageing problem rather than a national solution to it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Fertility decline in India is markedly uneven, with several states already at or below replacement level while parts of central and eastern India remain meaningfully above it, so a national aggregate masks the divergence that population questions are usually testing. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Ageing is the success of an earlier health and fertility transition arriving as a care, workforce and security problem, and its severity depends on how fast formal support has been built where fertility fell earliest rather than on the national age structure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the social implications of India's transition toward an ageing population structure....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or

source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss the objectives of population education and point out the measures India needs to adopt. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Population education earns its place when it builds informed voluntary capability about health, gender equality, marriage timing and resource pressure, and it fails the moment it is converted into a demographic-target campaign that coerces rather than informs.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards.
- The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target.
- Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome.
- Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context.
- A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation.

Qualified conclusion: Population education earns its place when it builds informed voluntary capability about health, gender equality, marriage timing and resource pressure, and it fails the moment it is converted into a demographic-target campaign that coerces rather than informs.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the objectives of population education and point out the measures India needs to...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Population education earns its place when it builds informed voluntary capability about health, gender equality, marriage timing and resource pressure, and it fails the moment it is converted into a demographic-target campaign that coerces rather than informs.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Population education is age-appropriate, scientific and rights-respecting education whose objectives group under reproductive and health information, gender equality and delayed marriage, informed and voluntary family-size choice, and awareness of the relationship between population and resources, delivered through schools, community outreach and health services within the National Population Policy, 2000 frame and with explicit anti-coercion safeguards. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Population Policy, 2000 of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare set an immediate objective of addressing unmet contraceptive need, a medium-term objective of bringing the Total Fertility Rate to replacement level and a long-term objective of a stable population by around 2045 aligned with sustainable development, and it is a rights-based tiered policy rather than a coercive numerical target. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Social determinants of fertility are the non-biological factors that shape childbearing decisions, namely women's educational attainment, age at marriage, employment, desired family size, contraceptive access and son preference, and their joint operation means no single determinant may be advanced as the sole cause of a fertility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's educational attainment is associated with later marriage, wider knowledge and use of contraception and a broader set of life options, which makes it the central social pathway in fertility transition, though its effect operates in interaction with service access, household income, prevailing norms and state context. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A National Family Health Survey estimate, a Census stock and an administrative registration figure are three different kinds of evidence, so a survey average must never be presented as a completed enumeration, as a current-year state figure or by itself as proof of causation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Population education earns its place when it builds informed voluntary capability about health, gender equality, marriage timing and resource pressure, and it fails the moment it is converted into a demographic-target campaign that coerces rather than informs.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the objectives of population education and point out the measures India needs to...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.